

(Don't Lie)



GAME JAM!

Tasks

Brainstorming game idea

Combine topics: "1 button" and "Heartbeat" ☒

Define the narrative and main mechanics ☒

Make a scene sketch ☒

Distribute tasks in the team ☒

Development

Make a 3D model of the hand ☒

Make 3 animations of the hand ☒

Make hand's texture ☒

Door model & texture ☒

Camera model & texture ☒

Add 2 bg sounds and set up Audio Manager script ☒

Notes

Well, this project was definitely a special one, because it started as part of a Game Jam. For me it was the first Game Jam in my life, so I was really excited and curious about it.

The main challenge of such event was that we needed to combine two topics: the topic of the «Game a Week» class and the topic of the «Berlin Mini Jam». However, I think this part went quite smoothly.

As soon as we joined into a team we had an idea, which was suggested by my teammate. She suggested the idea of the lie detector and game which goal is to normalise the heartbeat. We all really liked that idea and decided to go with it.

Then, after some brainstorming and discussion we started to work. Since the team was quite big (7 people), each person had their concrete task and didn't have to make many things at once. I was responsible for the 3D modeling of the hand. This model is the hand of the main character, who sees the game from the first-person view.

So, when I started working my goal for the next 8 hours was to make a low poly, but kind of realistic hand model, add texture and animations to it. However, the modelling process took longer than I had expected. For that reason, I spent the whole day only on modeling hand and making a very simple texture. In my opinion, it happened because I spent a lot of time on polishing the hand's proportions, so that it looks logical and realistic. Also, at the beginning I was making a model with an intention to polish it later, so I didn't pay attention to the parts that looked strange in the unsmoothed state. But later on I took a look at my teammates' models and understood that the low poly style of the hand would work better to make all the models be in the same style. That is why I needed some time to fix all the hard edges.

The next day after game jam I started working on the animations of the hand. The main problem for me was at the state of building the advanced skeleton in Maya, because it didn't allow me to create a non-symmetrical skeleton. I tried to find good options to fix that, however, I didn't succeed, so I just duplicated the hand model and created a symmetrical skeleton.

At this point the hardest part was behind. Because after that I just animated the hand (3 animations: 2 idle animations and 1 shaking animation, which is triggered, when the heartbeat minigame starts), set up the animator for it in Unity, drew a more detailed and color balanced texture, and then started to work on some other models.

For this project I also created the model of the door and the camera. The camera model is in the corner of the room and it has a red light attached to it, however, unfortunately, due to some post-processing, it is not seen very well.

The last thing that I did, was making a script for the Audio Manager and implementing two background sounds. Talking about the sounds, we decided to go just with some barely noticeable ones to remain the coherent mood of the game.

All in all, this project was very interesting for me. I worked on the game in such a big team for the first time, which felt unusual, because I didn't have to be worried about different parts of the game at the same time. I had my exact task, I was doing it, and all the other aspects were a responsibility of other people and I just trusted them and didn't interfere anyhow. Also, the Game Jam experience was a fun one. The only thing that I was nervous about, for the whole day I was feeling like we were over-scoping a bit and our idea was too big for such an event. But I am happy that I was wrong, because we managed to present our idea partially at the Game Jam and finish it fully by the final deadline.

Screenshots

